Neal T. Gillespie

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Hiring Committee
Mahon Library, Lubbock Municipal Libraries
City of Lubbock
1314 Avenue K, Lubbock, TX 79401

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the Part-Time Library Aide position at the Mahon Library. The work you are describing, emptying returns, sorting and routing items, reshelving accurately and keeping the shelves in order, is what I spend my working days doing now.

My title is Direct Mail Production Manager at Young Americans for Liberty, where I manage the archive of every printed piece we produce. One campaign might be a letter going out to the whole donor file, the next a proposal prepared for a single major donor, the next the invitation set for a conference. I take the samples in from the printer, sort and label them, shelve them by campaign and mail code, keep the shelves accurate, and pull what a writer or a director needs. I also designed the SQL database behind that archive and built a searchable catalog over it, so the whole department can find a past piece on its own.

The posting asks for someone who can complete detailed routines at a high rate of accuracy, and that is the claim I can evidence best. As a student registrar at Chapman University's Fowler School of Law I processed and approved more than five hundred transcripts, exam records and bar documents, where a misfiled record had real consequences. I staffed the service window as well, so helping somebody at a desk is familiar.

Before my current role I was Development Manager at the University of Austin, where part of my work was the campus library. I worked with a donor on a gift of a complete *Harvard Classics* set, handled it from the first conversation through to the books being on the shelf, gave them a tour of the library, and kept them updated on where the set had been placed. That is the work that turned a general interest in libraries into wanting to do this for a living.

Outside work I built two public websites: the Free Knowledge Library, a digital library of political literature drawn from across the ideological spectrum, where I designed the site, the database and the classification scheme and built the catalog readers search; and StateTrack, which publishes state campaign finance records for all fifty states.

I am studying for this work rather than drifting into it. I have begun the ALA's Library Support Staff Certification, which covers library organization and procedures, and I begin a Library and Information Services certificate at Central Community College in the spring, with a master's in library and information science to follow. I should say plainly that I am able to relocate. I am in Austin now, and I am willing to move anywhere in Texas a position requires.

Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the chance to talk about the role.

Sincerely,

Neal T. Gillespie